

PAUSECON

21-22 FEB 2026

BRUSSELS

PROGRAMME

SATURDAY AM



9:00	REGISTRATION & COFFEE	
9:30	WELCOME Joseph Miller & Didier Coeurnelle <i>PauseAI & Heales</i>	What to expect from PauseCon
9:40	ICEBREAKER: WHY ARE WE HERE? Irina Tavera, <i>PauseAI</i>	Get ready to mingle
10:10	WHY PAUSE? Maxime Fournes, <i>PauseAI</i>	Learn more about our movement and the roadmap towards a pause
10:35	UNDERSTANDING POWER & PRESSURE Irina Tavera, <i>PauseAI</i>	Learn how people-driven movements have been effective and how to apply key principles
11:20	COFFEE BREAK	
11:40	NARROW AI FOR HEALTH & LONGEVITY Didier Coeurnelle, <i>Heales</i>	The potential of non-superintelligent AI to facilitate the progress of humanity
12:10	LUNCH	
13:35	SKILLS SPEED DATING Irina Tavera, <i>PauseAI</i>	Expect a skills exchange: what are your strengths and what would you like to learn?

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13:35	SKILLS SPEED DATING Irina Tavera, <i>PauseAI</i>	Expect a skills exchange: what are your strengths and what would you like to learn?
14:20	GAIGANOW & GLOBAL GOVERNANCE Robert Whitfield, <i>GAIGANow</i>	Which global AI mechanisms exist and how might new ones work?
15:00	HOW TO ENGAGE THE PUBLIC Jonathan Moody & John Sherman <i>PauseAI & AI Risk Network</i>	A workshop in best practices: come equipped with ideas
15:45	COFFEE BREAK	
16:00	THE PAUSEAI ACTIVISM FUNNEL Liron Shapira, <i>Doom Debates</i>	A talk on grassroots organising and reflections from the podcast Doom Debates
16:25	SOCIAL MEDIA ACTION Matilda da Rui & Joseph Miller, <i>PauseAI</i>	A content-making session during which participants will connect to their networks
17:00	WRAP UP & GROUP PHOTO	A look ahead to Sunday
19:30	DINNER & SOCIAL	Dinner out in Brussels (optional)

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SUNDAY AM



9:00 COFFEE & NETWORKING

9:45 **WELCOME**

JOSEPH MILLER & DIDIER COEURNELLE
PauseAI & Heales

What's in store on day two of PauseCon

10:00 **THE MOTIVATION PARADOX**
David Wood, *London Futurists*

Workshop focusing on when initiatives failed and when they succeeded. Expect some soul-searching

10:30 **COALITION BUILDING**
Irina Tavera, *PauseAI*

How to maximise your network and tap into new ones to grow a coalition and create lasting impact

11:10 COFFEE BREAK

11:15 **CONTROLAI & CREATOR OUTREACH**
Max Winga, *ControlAI*

Two talks: expect to learn about ControlAI's approach and how they engage the public

12:05 LUNCH

13:35 **CRAFTING YOUR CALL TO ACTION**
Irina Tavera, *PauseAI*

Learn how to pitch to different audiences

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13:35	CRAFTING YOUR CALL TO ACTION Irina Tavera, <i>PauseAI</i>	Learn how to pitch to different audiences
14:20	SHOULDN'T WE JUST TALK ABOUT EXTINCTION? John Sherman & Max Winga <i>AI Risk Network & ControlAI</i>	A debate on how to best communicate the threat of existential risk
15:05	MAPPING ALLIES & STAKEHOLDERS Moritz Pohl & Irina Tavera, <i>PauseAI</i>	Learn to identify all stakeholders on a power map, including those that aren't on board with us
15:35	COFFEE BREAK	
15:45	COERCION OVER COOPERATION Axiom	The story of Axiom's legal challenge over the existential risk of AI
16:15	BUILDING A LOCAL CHAPTER Clémence Peyrot, <i>PauseAI</i>	How to build and grow a local PauseAI chapter
16:45	PAUSE AI VOLUNTEER CALL TO ACTION Irina Tavera, <i>PauseAI</i>	A talk about PauseAI volunteer opportunities
17:10	SIGN MAKING Joseph Miller, <i>PauseAI</i>	Dinner out in Brussels (optional)
17:40	WRAP UP Irina Tavera, <i>PauseAI</i>	How to stay connected and post-conference survey
19:00	DINNER & SOCIAL Didier Coeurnelle, <i>Heales</i>	Visit of the Grand-Place, Manneken Pis, Jeanneke Pis, Galeries Royales Saint-Hubert, followed by drinks and food (optional)

BEYOND THE AI ACT GLOBAL SECURITY & THE CONTROL PROBLEM

EUROPEAN PARLIAMENT
BRUSSELS

MONDAY 23 FEB



10:00 **ARRIVAL**

10:30 **INFORMAL NETWORKING**

10:45 **OPENING REMARKS**

Ondřej Kolář, MEP

11:00 **PAUSEAI POLICY PROPOSAL**

Maxime Fournes, *PauseAI*

11:20 **KEYNOTE ADDRESS**

Stuart Russell, *University of California*

The alignment problem and the unwinnable race

12:00 **PANEL DISCUSSION**

Speakers

Saskia Bricmont, MEP

Rudi Kennes, MEP

Victor Negrescu, *Vice president, European Parliament*

Brando Benifei, MEP

Loránt Vincze, MEP

Tomislav Sokol, MEP

André Rodrigues, MEP

Beyond the AI Act

Global security & the control problem

Moderated by Joseph Miller, *PauseAI*

12:45 **CLOSING REMARKS**

13:15 **LUNCH**

Visitors' restaurant, PHS Building, EUROPEAN Parliament

15:30 **DEMONSTRATION**

Place du Luxembourg